Developer onboarding

Welcome. This is everything **you** (a developer joining a project) need to do to start working in mykan and driving it from Claude Code. It picks up **after the project owner has added you** — two things happen on their side first:

1. **Your email is whitelisted** so you can sign in at all.
2. **The project is shared with you** so it's visible once you're in.

You don't do either of those — if you can't sign in or can't see the project, that's on the owner, not you (see Troubleshooting). Everything below is yours to do.

Use the **exact Google account** whose email the owner whitelisted. A different Google account — even yours — will be rejected. (For Gmail addresses, dots and `+tags` don't matter: `jane.doe@gmail.com` and `janedoe+work@gmail.com` are the same account, just as Google treats them.)

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1. Sign in

1. Go to **https://kanban.dbwoodward.com**.
2. Click **Sign in with Google** and pick the whitelisted account.
3. You land on your **projects list**. The project the owner shared with you is there — click it to open its board. Once you're inside a project, the back-chevron in the top bar (**Switch project**) jumps between projects.

If you see **"That account is not authorized to use Mykan,"** you signed in with the wrong Google account. Sign out and retry with the whitelisted one.

2. (Recommended) Connect your GitHub

If your project uses the GitHub integration (issues/PRs mirrored as cards), connect **your own** GitHub PAT so refreshes and write-backs are attributed to *you*, not a shared identity:

- Click the **GitHub icon** in the top bar and follow the connect flow.
- Full detail — token scopes, org-repo scoping, what syncs — is in `github-integration.md`.

Skip this if your project doesn't touch GitHub.

How GitHub works on a project

The wiring is set up once per project, usually by the owner:

1. **Project → GitHub account.** Click the **Edit project** pencil next to the project name and pick the account under **GitHub account**.

2. **Area → repo.** Open **Areas** at the right of the board toolbar (on a phone: the filter sheet → **Manage areas**). Hover an area and click **+ repo** to link it to a repo under that account.

After that, these are the controls, and exactly what each one does:

Control	Where	What it does	What it does not do
Sync (one area)	Areas panel, on a repo-linked area	Creates a Not Started card for each **open** issue in that repo that doesn't already have a card (archived cards count, so they don't come back), then moves each card whose issue was **closed on GitHub** to Done. The result shows on the area's row	Never reopens a card, never changes content, and doesn't touch the issues
Sync (all areas)	Right of the board toolbar (on a phone: the filter sheet → **Sync with GitHub**), or "*sync KANBAN with GitHub*"	Opens the Areas panel and syncs every repo-linked area there, one after another	Same as above
Refresh	A linked card's GitHub details on its card page (or "*refresh KANBAN-N from GitHub*")	Pulls that one issue's title, body and labels onto the card, overwriting them (the old version stays in history)	Never changes status, area or assignees
Done → closes the issue	Automatic, whenever a linked card moves	Moving a card to Done closes its issue; moving it out of Done reopens it, using **your** GitHub token	—
"not synced" badge	On a card whose close/reopen failed	Click to retry. If you have no GitHub token connected, connect one (above) first	—

Status flows **from mykan to GitHub** on every move. The one way it flows back is **Sync**: an issue closed on GitHub itself leaves its card where it is until someone runs Sync (or moves the card). Sync only shows once the project is linked to a GitHub account. The board toolbar's **Refresh** only reloads the board from mykan; it doesn't contact GitHub.

3. Connect Claude Code over MCP

This is what lets Claude Code (interactive **and** headless/cron) list your projects, move cards, edit items, and drive the GitHub tools **as you**. You need Claude Code installed first.

a. Mint your personal token

1. In mykan's top bar, click the **key icon** (🔑, next to the GitHub icon) → the **MCP access tokens** panel opens.
2. Optionally type a **label** (e.g. `laptop`, `cron agent`) so you can tell tokens apart later.
3. Click **Generate token**.
4. A `mk_…` value appears with **"Copy this token now — it won't be shown again."** Copy it immediately — only its hash is stored, so it is **unrecoverable** afterward. If you lose it, just generate another and revoke the old one.

The token carries **your identity and your GitHub PAT reach** — treat it like a password. Revoke any token from the same panel (the ✕); revocation is immediate.

b. Register with Claude Code

The panel shows a ready-to-paste command right under the token. It registers the server at **user scope** — available in every project on your machine, no repo secret, no approval prompt:

```
claude mcp add --transport http --scope user mykan \
  https://kanban.dbwoodward.com/mcp \
  --header "Authorization: Bearer <your mk_… token>"
```

The **same** command and token work for headless/cron agents — there is no browser step. (Interactive browser OAuth — an "Authenticate → Google" button — is **not** built; the token is the intended mechanism and is actually simpler for headless use.)

c. Verify

```
claude mcp get mykan          # should show ✔ Connected
```

Then in a Claude Code session, `/mcp` (or `/tools`) should list the mykan tools: `mcp__mykan__list_projects`, `mcp__mykan__update_item_status`, and the rest. Your token lives only in `~/.claude.json` on your machine — never in the repo.

> If you registered before new tools shipped, restart the session — MCP tool lists load once per session.

4. Work

Ask Claude Code naturally — it maps to the tools:

- "*List my mykan projects / items in Permit Saige*" → `list_projects`, `list_items`
- "*Move KANBAN-N to In Progress / Done*" → `update_item_status`
- "*Create a task in Permit Saige: …*" → `create_item`
- "*Refresh KANBAN-N from GitHub*" → `refresh_item_from_github`
- "*Sync KANBAN with GitHub*" → `sync_project_with_github`
- "*Show me KANBAN-N*" → `get_item` (description, decisions, open questions, progress summary; attached files via `get_attachment`)
- "*Show me epic PS-N and its cards*" / "*status of PS-N*" → `epic_table` (a ready-made table: #, Card, Type, Status, Note, with the epic on top and its cards in the epic's order; the note is each card's title)
- "*Tag / assign / re-parent KANBAN-N*" → `set_item_tags`, `set_item_assignees`, `set_item_parent`, `set_item_area`

How a card is organised

Every card has more than a description, and Claude Code is told to keep each thing in its place:

- **Description** — a clean, living spec (objective, scope, plan, acceptance), edited in place with `set_item_body` when the plan changes. Old versions are kept in the item's history.
- **Progress notes** — one short checkpoint per meaningful step (`append_item_note`). Progress never goes in the description.
- **Questions** — anything the card leaves undecided (`ask_question`), closed with `answer_question` once the owner decides.
- **Decisions** — what the project owner decided (`record_decision`). Your agent records decisions; it doesn't make them.

Entries are editable and versioned (`update_item_entry`, `list_item_entry_versions`, `restore_item_entry_version`), and each is capped at 2,000 characters. Put longer detail in the repo or the PR and link it.

Full tool list and semantics: `mcp-setup.md`.

If the owner installed the **work-item** skill for you, you can also say "*work the next Permit Saige item*" and Claude Code will pick it up, move it to In Progress, do the build from its description, and move it to Done.

Troubleshooting

Symptom	Cause	Fix
"That account is not authorized" on sign-in	Wrong Google account, or not whitelisted yet	Use the whitelisted account; if it still fails, the owner needs to whitelist your email (for Gmail, dots and `+tags` are ignored, so a different spelling of the same address is fine)
Signed in, but the project isn't listed	Project not shared with you	Ask the owner to share it (adds you to the project's members)
`claude mcp get mykan` shows not connected	Bad/typo'd token, or token revoked	Re-mint a token (§3a) and re-run the `claude mcp add` command
Tools missing in a session after connecting, or calls fail after a mykan deploy	Tool list and MCP session are cached for the Claude Code session	Restart the Claude Code session (or reconnect with `/mcp`)
GitHub refresh/write-back fails	No GitHub PAT connected, or wrong scopes	Connect your PAT (§2); see `github-integration.md` for scopes
An issue was closed on GitHub but its card is still open	Status only comes back from GitHub when someone syncs	Click **Sync** on the board toolbar (§2)

See also

- `mcp-setup.md` — the MCP server, tools, and how auth works
- `github-integration.md` — GitHub PAT setup and sync
- `DESIGN.md` — mykan's interaction patterns